

James Litchfield

Full-Stack Engineer | TypeScript, React, Node.js

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Summary

Remote-first full-stack engineer with 6+ years of experience building web products in TypeScript, React, Node.js and Ruby on Rails. I own features across the client, server and database, with a focus on accessibility, Core Web Vitals and automated testing. My favourite work removes a bottleneck for someone else, like a CMS marketing can publish from without engineering. I try new tools early, such as modern browser APIs and an AI-assisted review workflow built on Claude and MCP, and I share what works through code review, pairing and technical showcases.

Skills

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Ruby, HTML, CSS

Frontend: React (function components, hooks), Next.js, Vite, Tailwind CSS

Backend: Node.js, NestJS, Ruby on Rails, Sidekiq, GraphQL, REST APIs

Databases: PostgreSQL (Postgres), MongoDB

Testing: Cypress, Playwright, Storybook, Chromatic, RSpec, automated testing, A/B testing

Accessibility and performance: Accessibility (WCAG 2.2), Core Web Vitals, performance optimisation, Lighthouse, PageSpeed Insights, Cloudinary, search engine optimisation (SEO), Heap

Delivery and monitoring: Git, CI/CD (GitHub Actions), Bugsnag

AI tooling: Cursor, Claude, GitHub Copilot, MCP servers

Earlier experience: Swift, SwiftUI, PHP, WordPress, Xamarin

Work Experience

Product Engineer | Scan.com | London (remote) | November 2022 – May 2026

Medical imaging scale-up operating across the UK and US, with 200+ UK scanning centres.

- Owned the redesign of fullbodyscan.com (Rails) in a two-person pod. Set the page architecture and UI, and rebuilt the site to improve WCAG 2.2 accessibility. The new site raised conversion 12% and cut bounce rate 9% against the previous implementation (measured in Heap).
- Designed and built a CMS (Rails, React) that lets marketing publish SEO landing pages without engineering support. It launched with 20 pages and saved an estimated 30 engineer-days during the initial rollout.
- Designed and shipped an embeddable booking widget that extends Scan.com's booking experience to partner domains, and piloted it with one partner before onboarding 2 more.
- Maintained and extended the booking platform (Rails, React, TypeScript, Postgres) across multiple interconnected sites. Added payment integrations, validation workflows and internal ops tooling, and tested cross-site data changes to prevent regressions. This cut manual ops time by an estimated 30%.
- Performed code reviews on pull requests from all engineers on the team and paired regularly with other developers to share knowledge and spread team practices. Codified the team's established practices into an AI-assisted review workflow (Claude and Notion MCP), so a review agent could check changes against them.
- Improved Core Web Vitals across Scan.com's connected domains, including a migration to Cloudinary for image optimisation. Real-user LCP (measured in PageSpeed Insights) dropped from ~4s to under 2s, and CLS fell to 0.01.
- Introduced modern browser APIs and progressive enhancement patterns, cutting client-side JavaScript by ~10%. Worked with design to document these patterns in a component library (Vite, Storybook) and presented it to the engineering team in technical showcases.
- Ran production support and on-call triage across the Rails and React applications. Used Bugsnag and Sidekiq to debug errors and failed jobs, and followed issues through to resolution.

Mid-Level Web Developer | Dexerto | London (remote) | January 2021 – November 2022

Scale-up news outlet covering gaming and internet culture, with 30M monthly visitors in 2022.

- Redesigned dexerto.com (Next.js, TypeScript, GraphQL). Improved search engine optimisation (SEO) and lifted organic traffic by ~15%.
- Wrote custom PHP plugins that extended the headless WordPress GraphQL API, exposing custom post fields and ad slots to the Next.js frontend.
- Implemented infinite scroll across article pages, contributing to a ~20% increase in pages per session and ~10% increase in Google ad impressions, when A/B tested.
- Worked with design to build the React component library behind the Next.js UI of mystats.com (tables, charts, live stats, maps).
- Set up automated testing across all domains with Storybook, Chromatic, Playwright and Cypress. The tests covered core components and critical user flows, and caught visual regressions before release.

Full-Stack Developer | Eledev Digital | Liverpool (remote) | May 2020 – January 2021

Early-stage start-up specialising in mobile app development.

- Started as a freelancer in May 2020 and moved to a full-time role in July 2020.
- Co-developed the Hour Blocks (Swift, SwiftUI) iOS app, which received 100,000+ downloads and Apple "App of the Day" in 150+ countries.
- Built the NestJS and MongoDB backend for Pro Wrestling Simulator online persistence, supporting 300+ registered users.

Junior Developer | Kmatic | Liverpool (remote) | May 2020 – July 2020

Company providing customisable solutions for the collection, analysis and processing of geospatial data.

- Delivered features for a Xamarin mobile app and internal data-processing tools, and assessed ARKit/ARCore feasibility.

Education

BSc Computer Science (1st class) | University of Liverpool | 2017 – 2020